

NEOLITHIC AND CHALCOLITHIC CULTURES

CONTINUOUS AT-A-GLANCE MASTER • CORE FIRST • REGIONAL • EVIDENCE-BOUND

Food production -> regional sequences -> Chalcolithic networks -> social inference -> transition controls

01

STAGE 01 DEFINITIONS AND EVIDENCE CONTROL

Neolithic = diagnostic bundle, not one tool

Chalcolithic = copper + continuing stone

Culture label != people, language or polity

TRAP / LIMIT: Test trait, region, context and date separately.

ANSWER LINE: Define -> evidence -> inference -> limit.

02

STAGE 02 FOOD PRODUCTION: REGIONAL MOSAIC

foraging and management continue

cultivation/herding adopted unevenly

storage and settlement change at different rates

TRAP / LIMIT: Reject a sudden universal revolution.

ANSWER LINE: Consequential change; asynchronous process.

03

STAGE 03 DOMESTICATION EVIDENCE LADDER

1. plants: morphology + weeds + residues + dates

2. animals: culling + pens/dung + pathology + dates

3. presence != cultivation/management != domestication

TRAP / LIMIT: Wild/domestic ambiguity remains real.

ANSWER LINE: Use converging evidence, never one specimen.

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04

STAGE 04 REGIONAL NEOLITHIC MAP

Mehrgarh: Baluchistan, Pakistan

Burzahom-Gufkral: Kashmir

Koldihwa-Mahagara-Lahuradewa: rice caveats

Chirand: eastern mixed economy

Daojali Hading: bounded north-east claims

Utnur-Piklihal-Hallur-Brahmagiri: southern sequence

TRAP / LIMIT: Map sites with present geography and diagnostic evidence.

ANSWER LINE: No single all-India date or pathway.

05

STAGE 05 TOOLS, POTTERY, HOUSES AND STORAGE

polished stone + microliths + bone coexist

pottery may follow food production

houses and bins alter labour and access

sedentism and mobility can coexist

TRAP / LIMIT: Association is not necessity.

ANSWER LINE: New material choices accumulate unevenly.

06

STAGE 06 PASTORALISM AND ASH MOUNDS

1. herds + crops + wild foods + exchange

2. dung accumulation -> repeated burning

3. practical, communal and ritual functions may overlap

TRAP / LIMIT: No one ash-mound explanation fits every site.

ANSWER LINE: Cattle-centred does not mean crop-free.

07

STAGE 07 CHALCOLITHIC REGIONAL MATRIX

Ahar-Banas: black-red ware and copper

Kayatha/Malwa: central-western sequences

Savalda: early western-Deccan horizon

Jarvis: painted ware and hierarchy

eastern cultures: rice/fish and regional houses

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TRAP / LIMIT: Copper does not create urbanism or uniformity.

ANSWER LINE: Compare region, ware, settlement, crops and exchange.

08

STAGE 08 GANESHWAR-JODHPURA AND Khetri

ore zone -> extraction/craft

copper artefacts -> exchange

Harappan similarities -> contact question

TRAP / LIMIT: Contact and partial overlap do not prove control.

ANSWER LINE: Commodity chain before political conclusion.

09

STAGE 09 INAMGAON: RURAL COMPLEXITY

1. houses + storage + craft + burials

2. settlement hierarchy and unequal access

3. changing subsistence and later contraction

TRAP / LIMIT: Chiefdom/state remain interpretive models.

ANSWER LINE: Use deeply as one Jorwe micro-case.

10

STAGE 10 INEQUALITY, BURIALS AND RITUAL

house/storage differences

rare copper, beads and craft concentration

grave goods and human-animal burials

TRAP / LIMIT: Treatment is visible; theology and hereditary rank are not.

10

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ANSWER LINE: Observation -> alternatives -> confidence.

11

STAGE 11 ENVIRONMENT, HARAPPAN AND IRON TRANSITIONS

drought requires date + mechanism + alternatives

Harappan urbanism overlaps but differs in scale

iron and Early Historic forms spread unevenly

TRAP / LIMIT: Abandonment is not automatic collapse.

ANSWER LINE: Continuity and reorganisation outlast labels.

12

STAGE 12 PYQ, TRAPS AND ANSWER SPINE

1. 2021: Burzahom wrong; Chandraketugarh and Ganeshwar right

2. site -> region -> period -> marker -> caveat

3. Mains: define -> compare -> analyse -> qualify -> verdict

TRAP / LIMIT: Inferred key: 2 and 3 only; official local key unavailable.

ANSWER LINE: Regional mosaic, not one people or inevitable ladder.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED — ONLY AFTER THE CORE

- Competing domestication theories are hypotheses with different regional weights.
- Rice taxonomy, ash-mound formation, taphonomy and household models refine—not replace—the core.
- Chiefdom, ritual and migration interpretations require converging evidence and explicit alternatives.

FINAL VERDICT: overlapping regional experiments — not one revolution, people or inevitable ladder.